

## UNIT

## 45



## THE OFFICE

## CONVERSATION

**Livia:** Hey! What were you doing yesterday afternoon? I texted you about the report.

**Rafael:** Oh, I saw it later! I was working on those spreadsheets and reviewing contracts at the same time. I didn't even check WhatsApp.

**Livia:** Ok. I was also dealing with a lot—I was writing emails, answering calls, and working on a spreadsheet too.

**Rafael:** Exactly! While I was updating the sales file, people kept calling me left and right. It was hard to focus.

**Livia:** Oh, it's so annoying. I was trying to print those slides for the meeting, but the printer wasn't working properly. It took me a lot of time.

**Rafael:** Ugh, it never works when we need it.

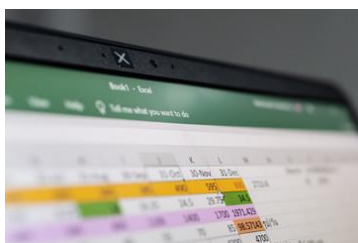
**Livia:** We were both doing a million things. No wonder we didn't reply to each other.

**Rafael:** True. At one point, I was just hoping the day would end—ready to call it a day.

**Livia:** Same here. But hey—we made it through.



## VOCABULARY



Work on  
spreadsheets



Make  
charts



Give a  
presentation



Have a meeting



Talk to a client



Review a contract



Join a video call



Check emails

## Expressions

**Left and right:** in a very quick and uncontrolled way

**Call it a day:** stop working.

**Made it through:** succeed in face of a difficult situation.

### LANGUAGE PRACTICE



What **were you doing** when I called you?

**I was talking** to a client.



What **was Paulo doing** at the time of the presentation?

**He was reviewing** a contract.



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## EXERCISE 1

Use the past continuous. Fill in the blanks.

A. I was working on the sales file when the printer stopped working.

(work on the sales file)

B. While she \_\_\_\_\_, the client arrived.

(review a contract)

C. They \_\_\_\_\_, so I couldn't focus.

(call me left and right)

D. He \_\_\_\_\_ while I was in a meeting.

(fix the printer)

E. We \_\_\_\_\_, so we didn't see the message.

(deal with a million things)

## EXERCISE 2

Complete the sentences using your own experience.

A. Yesterday at 10 a.m., I \_\_\_\_\_.

B. While I was working last week, \_\_\_\_\_.

C. During the last meeting, I \_\_\_\_\_.

D. At lunchtime yesterday, I \_\_\_\_\_.

E. When my colleague texted me, I \_\_\_\_\_.

## SUMMARY

| Subject           | Verb “to be” | Verb (ing)              | Example                                  |
|-------------------|--------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| I / He / She / It | was          | working, printing, etc. | She <b>was working</b> on a spreadsheet. |
| You / We / They   | were         | fixing, reviewing, etc. | They <b>were fixing</b> the printer.     |

## EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

### Exercise 1

- A. was working on the sales file
- B. was reviewing a contract
- C. were calling me left and right
- D. was fixing the printer
- E. were dealing with a million things

### Exercise 2

Answers vary.